Skill Photo — Shortcuts & Guide

Generated 2026-10-16 from the app's own command table · macOS and Windows / Linux

WHAT SKILL PHOTO IS

A non-destructive, layer-based photo editor for desktop (Tauri) and the browser. Everything runs locally on your machine: adjustments render on the GPU (WebGL2), and object removal uses a content-aware fill (multi-scale PatchMatch) that runs in a background thread. Projects save as **.photoscale** files with every layer, mask and adjustment intact; unsaved work is autosaved for crash recovery every 45 seconds.

Workflow essentials

- **Open** images with `⌘O`, drag-and-drop, or paste (`⌘V`). Shift-drop places files as layers.
- **Adjust** — every adjustment goes on its own maskable adjustment layer. Presets: Pop, Teal & Orange, Golden Hour, Moody B&W, Clean Portrait, Faded Film, Crisp Landscape, Noir, Cool Matte, High Key, Neon Night, Antique.
- **Auto Enhance** analyses the photo and builds a tuned adjustment layer you can keep editing.
- **Remove objects** — paint over them with the Spot Healing Brush, or select and press `⇧⌫`.
- **Masks** — paint black to hide, white to reveal; `Q` toggles mask editing.
- **Run anything** from the command palette, `⌘K`.

Filters (live preview, respect selections)

Blur: Gaussian Blur, Motion Blur
Sharpen: Unsharp Mask, High Pass
Noise: Add Noise, Reduce Noise
Stylize: Pixelate, Emboss, Find Edges
Creative: Dreamy Glow (Orton), Chromatic Aberration, Halftone Dots

Adjustment panel

Light, Color, Presence & Effects, Curves, Levels, Color Mixer (HSL), Color Grading.

Pointer precision: paint lands exactly under the pointer. Brush **Smoothing** (options bar) adds a stabilizer: paint follows the pointer on a string of that length, drawn on screen, and every stroke still ends exactly where you release. Pen pressure controls size (and optionally opacity). Zoom with `⌘+` / `⌘−`, pinch, or ⌘-scroll; the point under the cursor stays put. `⌘0` fits, `⌘1` is 100%, hold `Space` to pan with any tool. Moving a layer snaps its edges and centre to the canvas and to other layers, with guides on screen; hold ⌘ to move freely. On Windows / Linux use Ctrl where macOS uses ⌘.

TOOLS

- **Move** (V) — Drag to move the layer. ⌘-click picks the layer under the cursor. With a selection, moves the selected pixels.
- **Rectangular Marquee** (M) — Shift = add, ⌥ = subtract. Shift while dragging = square.
- **Elliptical Marquee** (M) — Shift = add, ⌥ = subtract.
- **Single Row Marquee** (M) — Click to select a 1-pixel row across the canvas. Shift adds, ⌥ subtracts.
- **Single Column Marquee** (M) — Click to select a 1-pixel column down the canvas.
- **Lasso** (L) — Draw freehand. Pair with Shift+⌫ to remove objects.
- **Polygonal Lasso** (L) — Click points; double-click or Enter to close.
- **Object Selection** (W) — Drag a box around an object, or click it — the selection snaps to its edges. Shift adds, ⌥ subtracts.
- **Quick Selection** (W) — Paint over an object — on release the selection snaps to its real edges. ⌥ subtracts.
- **Magic Wand** (W) — Select similar colors. Tolerance in the options bar.
- **Crop** (C) — Drag handles, Enter to apply, Esc to cancel. Non-destructive by default.
- **Eyedropper** (I) — Click to sample color. ⌥ samples to background.
- **Color Sampler** (I) — Click to pin up to 10 color readouts (Info panel). Drag to move, ⌥-click to remove.
- **Ruler** (I) — Drag to measure distance and angle. "Straighten Layer" levels the line.
- **Spot Healing Brush** (J) — Paint over blemishes or objects — they vanish (content-aware).
- **Healing Brush** (J) — ⌥-click a clean area, then paint: texture from the source, color and light from around the stroke.
- **Red Eye** (J) — Click an eye or drag a box around it to neutralize red pupils.
- **Clone Stamp** (S) — ⌥-click to set the source, then paint.
- **Brush** (B) — [ ] size, ⇧[ ] hardness, 1–0 opacity, ⌥-click to sample.
- **Pencil** (B) — Hard-edged, aliased strokes for pixel art.
- **Color Replacement** (B) — Recolor with the foreground color while keeping shading and texture.
- **History Brush** (Y) — Paint pixels back from a history state. Pick the state in History (brush icon).
- **Eraser** (E) — Erase to transparency.
- **Background Eraser** (E) — Erases the color under the brush centre and keeps edges of other colors.
- **Magic Eraser** (E) — Click to erase all similar connected pixels (Tolerance in the options bar).
- **Gradient** (G) — Drag to draw. On a mask = graduated filter.
- **Paint Bucket** (G) — Flood fill similar colors.
- **Blur** (R) — Soften details locally.
- **Sharpen** (R) — Crisp up details locally.
- **Smudge** (R) — Push pixels around like wet paint.
- **Dodge** (O) — Lighten areas. Choose tonal range in the options bar.
- **Burn** (O) — Darken areas.
- **Sponge** (O) — Saturate or desaturate locally.
- **Pen** (P) — Click for corners, drag for curves. Click the first point to close. Enter finishes, Esc cancels, ⌫ removes a point.
- **Type** (T) — Click to add text, click existing text to edit.
- **Shape** (U) — Drag to draw vector shapes. Shift constrains.
- **Hand** (H) — Pan. Hold Space anywhere for a quick pan.
- **Zoom** (Z) — Click to zoom in, ⌥-click out. Pinch / ⌘-scroll also zoom.

KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS — MENUS

File menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
New	⌘N	Ctrl+N
New from Template	⌘⌥N	Ctrl+Alt+N
Social Studio	⌘⌥⇧M	Ctrl+Alt+Shift+M
Open	⌘O	Ctrl+O
Place Image as Layer	⌘⇧P	Ctrl+Shift+P
Save Project (.photoscale)	⌘S	Ctrl+S
Export As	⌘⌥⇧W	Ctrl+Alt+Shift+W
Close Document	⌘W	Ctrl+W

Edit menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Undo	⌘Z	Ctrl+Z
Redo	⌘⇧Z	Ctrl+Shift+Z
Cut	⌘X	Ctrl+X
Copy	⌘C	Ctrl+C
Copy Merged	⌘⇧C	Ctrl+Shift+C
Clear / Delete	⌫	Del
Fill with Foreground	⌥⌫	Alt+Del
Fill with Background	⌘⌫	Ctrl+Del
Content-Aware Fill (Remove Object)	⇧⌫	Shift+Del
Free Transform	⌘T	Ctrl+T
Preferences	⌘,	Ctrl+,

Image menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Looks	⌘⇧K	Ctrl+Shift+K
Auto Enhance (Smart Tune)	⌘⇧L	Ctrl+Shift+L
Auto Contrast	⌘⌥⇧L	Ctrl+Alt+Shift+L
Auto Color	⌘⇧B	Ctrl+Shift+B
Image Size	⌘⌥I	Ctrl+Alt+I
Canvas Size	⌘⌥C	Ctrl+Alt+C

Select menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Subject	⌘⌥⇧S	Ctrl+Alt+Shift+S
Select and Mask	⌘⌥R	Ctrl+Alt+R
All	⌘A	Ctrl+A
Deselect	⌘D	Ctrl+D
Reselect	⌘⇧D	Ctrl+Shift+D
Inverse	⌘⇧I	Ctrl+Shift+I
Feather	⇧F6	Shift+F6

Filter menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Repeat Last Filter	⌘⌥F	Ctrl+Alt+F
Liquify	⌘⇧X	Ctrl+Shift+X

View menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Zoom In	⌘+	Ctrl++
Zoom Out	⌘–	Ctrl+–
Fit on Screen	⌘0	Ctrl+0
100%	⌘1	Ctrl+1
Zoom to Selection / Layer	⌘⌥0	Ctrl+Alt+0
Before / After (hide adjustments)	\	\
Rulers	⌘R	Ctrl+R
Proof Colors (CMYK Print)	⌘Y	Ctrl+Y
Gamut Warning	⌘⇧Y	Ctrl+Shift+Y
Grid	⌘'	Ctrl+'
Safe Zones	⌘⇧'	Ctrl+Shift+'
Snap to Grid	⌘⌥'	Ctrl+Alt+'
Layout Grids	⌘;	Ctrl+;
Auto Grid	⌘⌥;	Ctrl+Alt+;
Focus Mode (hide panels)	Tab	Tab
Command Palette	⌘K	Ctrl+K

Help menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Keyboard Shortcuts	⌘/	Ctrl+/

Layer menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
New Layer	`⌘⇧N`	`Ctrl+Shift+N`
New Adjustment Layer	`⌘⌥A`	`Ctrl+Alt+A`
Group Layers	`⌘G`	`Ctrl+G`
Ungroup Layers	`⌘⇧G`	`Ctrl+Shift+G`
Shape ▸ Make Compound Path	`⌘8`	`Ctrl+8`
Shape ▸ Release Compound Path	`⌘⌥⇧8`	`Ctrl+Alt+Shift+8`
Shape ▸ Join Path Endpoints	`⌘⌥J`	`Ctrl+Alt+J`
Transform ▸ Transform Again	`⌘D`	`Ctrl+D`
Transform ▸ Transform Each	`⌘⌥⇧D`	`Ctrl+Alt+Shift+D`
Layer via Copy	`⌘J`	`Ctrl+J`
Layer via Cut	`⌘⇧J`	`Ctrl+Shift+J`
Create / Release Clipping Mask	`⌘⌥G`	`Ctrl+Alt+G`
Layer Style	`⌘⌥Y`	`Ctrl+Alt+Y`
Lock Transparency	`/`	`/`
Bring Forward	`⌘]`	`Ctrl+]`
Send Backward	`⌘[`	`Ctrl+[`
Merge Down / Merge Selected	`⌘E`	`Ctrl+E`
Merge Visible	`⌘⇧E`	`Ctrl+Shift+E`
Stamp Visible to New Layer	`⌘⌥⇧E`	`Ctrl+Alt+Shift+E`

KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS — TOOLS, BRUSH & POINTER

Tools

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Move	`V`	`V`
Rectangular Marquee	`M`	`M`
Elliptical Marquee	`⇧M`	`Shift+M`
Single Row Marquee	`⇧M`	`Shift+M`
Single Column Marquee	`⇧M`	`Shift+M`
Lasso	`L`	`L`
Polygonal Lasso	`⇧L`	`Shift+L`
Object Selection	`W`	`W`
Quick Selection	`⇧W`	`Shift+W`
Magic Wand	`⇧W`	`Shift+W`
Crop	`C`	`C`
Eyedropper	`I`	`I`
Color Sampler	`⇧I`	`Shift+I`
Ruler	`⇧I`	`Shift+I`
Spot Healing Brush	`J`	`J`
Healing Brush	`⇧J`	`Shift+J`
Red Eye	`⇧J`	`Shift+J`
Clone Stamp	`S`	`S`
Brush	`B`	`B`
Pencil	`⇧B`	`Shift+B`
Color Replacement	`⇧B`	`Shift+B`
History Brush	`Y`	`Y`
Eraser	`E`	`E`
Background Eraser	`⇧E`	`Shift+E`
Magic Eraser	`⇧E`	`Shift+E`
Gradient	`G`	`G`
Paint Bucket	`⇧G`	`Shift+G`
Blur	`R`	`R`
Sharpen	`⇧R`	`Shift+R`
Smudge	`⇧R`	`Shift+R`
Dodge	`O`	`O`
Burn	`⇧O`	`Shift+O`
Sponge	`⇧O`	`Shift+O`
Pen	`P`	`P`
Type	`T`	`T`
Shape	`U`	`U`
Hand	`H`	`H`
Zoom	`Z`	`Z`

Brush, color & pointer

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Brush size	`[ ]`	`[ ]`
Brush hardness	`Shift [ ]`	`Shift [ ]`
Tool opacity 10% … 100%	`1 … 0`	`1 … 0`
Swap / default colors	`X / D`	`X / D`
Toggle mask editing	`Q`	`Q`
Pan (any tool)	`Space + drag`	`Space + drag`
Zoom at cursor	`Pinch / ⌘ + scroll`	`Ctrl + wheel`
Pan vertically / horizontally	`Scroll / Shift + scroll`	`Scroll / Shift + scroll`
Pick the layer under the cursor	`⌘-click (move)`	`Ctrl-click (move)`
Move without snapping to guides	`⌘ while moving`	`Ctrl while moving`
Resize brush: → size, ↑ hardness	`^⌥ + drag (brush)`	`Alt + right-drag (brush)`
Sample color	`⌥-click (brush)`	`Alt-click (brush)`
Set clone source	`⌥-click (clone)`	`Alt-click (clone)`
Add / subtract	`Shift / ⌥ (selections)`	`Shift / Alt (selections)`
Constrain: square, 45°, straight line	`Shift (drag)`	`Shift (drag)`
Commit / cancel crop, transform, polygon, pen path	`Enter / Esc`	`Enter / Esc`
Remove the last path point	`⌫ (pen)`	`⌫ (pen)`
Select several layers / a range	`⌘-click / Shift-click (layers)`	`Ctrl-click / Shift-click (layers)`
Set healing source	`⌥-click (healing brush)`	`Alt-click (healing brush)`
Remove a sampler	`⌥-click (color sampler)`	`Alt-click (color sampler)`
Nudge layer (Shift = 10px)	`Arrows`	`Arrows`
Fit on screen	`Double-click (hand)`	`Double-click (hand)`

Regenerate with **npm run docs:shortcuts** · keys come from src/core/commands.ts and src/ui/ToolRail.tsx